

- **2007** Fatal merger with Indian Airlines creates massive losses
- **2017** Cabinet approves privatisation after years of mounting losses

## PRIVATISATION PROCESS (2017-2022)



- **March 2018** First attempt to privatise fails; No bidders for 76% stake with ₹33,392 crore debt
- **January 2020** Second attempt; 100% stake offered with reduced debt burden
- **October 8, 2021** Tata Group wins bid for ₹18,000 crore, outbidding SpiceJet's Ajay Singh



- **January 27, 2022** Air India returns to Tata after 69 years

- **2023-2024** Massive fleet retrofit programme (\$400 million) and workforce renewal

- **February 2023** Record aircraft order—570 planes worth \$70 billion (₹7 lakh crore) from Airbus and Boeing.

- **November 2022** Vistara's merger with Singapore Airlines announced

- **September 2022** Vihaan.AI, AI's five-year transformation programme, launched

- **June 2022** Campbell Wilson appointed as CEO & Managing Director

## TRANSFORMATION PHASE (2022-2024)



PHOTO BY HARDIK CHHABRA

## INTEGRATION AND GROWTH (2024)

- **November 12, 2024** Vistara merger completed—Singapore Airlines gets 25.1% stake
- **Post-merger** Combined fleet of 308+ aircraft, making it India's largest international carrier

**\$70  
BILLION**

**Air India  
has placed  
record aircraft  
order—570  
planes—from  
Airbus and  
Boeing**

| 41

₹10,859 crore, an increase of about 48% from the previous year, while the revenue grew 18% to ₹78,636 crore. The dismal performance of the airline also impacted Singapore Airlines' profitability. Its net income dropped 59% to \$145 million in the three months ended June 30, dragged by losses at Air India.

According to analysts, Tata Sons will have to inject ₹20,000 crore and ₹25,000 crore each year for fleet modernisation, technology upgrades, and working capital requirements. For a multi-diversified group with AAA credit ratings, this represents not just a financial commitment but a

reputation-defining gamble.

Despite all the progress the airline has made under its transformation plan—such as new aircraft orders, better technology, infrastructure investments, and branding—the crash, according to several analysts and former airline executives *Business Today* spoke to,